

But the most popular standards being used in the home automation industry are Z-wave and ZigBee. Both the standards have lower bandwidth than Wi-Fi and Bluetooth, but consume very less power. In fact, several smart devices using these technologies work for as long as a year even on a watch battery and don't even need high bandwidths. These standards were specifically designed while keeping home automation in mind and hence take care of many of the problems faced while using other technologies. Both are inexpensive, have low power consumption and enough bandwidth to sustain all the functions of most of the smart devices. These standards are explained in further detail in the following chapters but the important thing to know is whether they are inter-compatible.

So, if you already have smart devices in your home and are looking for a smart hub, then make sure that you pick one which is compatible with all of them. If you are building everything from scratch, our suggestion would be to first select the best hub to suit your needs and then pick up various compatible devices.

The 'smartest' smart hub of all

There are a few smart hubs available in the market right now, from big names like Amazon, Samsung to several other companies like Wink, Honeywell and Insteaon. Google has been foraying into the world of automation with acquiring one of the leading names in the industry, Nest, and is soon going to launch its portable speaker cum hub called Google Home, powered by its voice assistant. Let's check out all the available options now.

Samsung SmartThings V2

Samsung acquired the US based company, SmartThings, one of the first company to launch a home automation hub, in the year 2014. Samsung launched the 2nd generation of SmartThings Hub which is said to be one of the best smart hubs available in the market right now. Priced at around ₹13000, it is one of the most versatile, and easy to use hubs and comes packed with a variety of features. It supports all the common connectivity standards including Wi-Fi, Bluetooth LE, Z-Wave and ZigBee making it compatible, at least on paper, with almost all of your potential smart devices.

Samsung has also come out with its own limited range of SmartThings devices which include window, door and motion sensors, all of which are fully compatible with the hub out of the box.